

**TWENTY-FOURTH NORTHERN MARIANAS COMMONWEALTH**

**LEGISLATURE**

**IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES**

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Session, 2026

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H. J. R. 24-19

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**A HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION**

To approve the Governor's request to exempt and fill a critical and vacant personnel position within the Office of the Governor, pursuant to Public Law 24-20, Section 602(a).

1           **WHEREAS**, the Twenty-Fourth Northern Marianas Commonwealth  
2           Legislature enacted Public Law 24-20, also known as the Revised Appropriations  
3           and Budget Authority Act of 2026; and

4           **WHEREAS**, Section 602(a) of Public Law 24-20 mandates a freeze on  
5           filling new or vacant positions within the Executive Branch, except for positions  
6           essential to the delivery of public services; and

7           **WHEREAS**, Section 602(a) provides a mechanism to exempt critical  
8           vacancies from this freeze upon the formal determination and certification of the  
9           Governor, subject to approval by the Legislature via a joint resolution; and

10          **WHEREAS**, the Office of the Governor serves as the central hub for  
11          executive operations, crisis management, and the continuous administration of  
12          public services throughout the Commonwealth; and

1           **WHEREAS**, the physical infrastructure, facility systems, and operational  
2       safety of the executive complexes require continuous, dedicated upkeep to prevent  
3       hazardous working conditions and costly structural degradation; and

4           **WHEREAS**, a vacancy in the General Maintenance position compromises  
5       the daily operations of the executive branch, creates safety vulnerabilities, and  
6       hinders the facility support required by administrative staff to deliver services to  
7       the public; and

8           **WHEREAS**, through Governor's Communication 24-165, the Governor  
9       has formally certified to the Legislature that a specific vacant personnel position  
10      within the Office of the Governor is essential for the delivery of public services;  
11      and

12          **WHEREAS**, the Legislature recognizes that maintaining the operational  
13      integrity of the Commonwealth's executive offices is a necessary public purpose  
14      that warrants an exemption from the hiring freeze;

15          **NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED**, by the House of  
16      Representatives of the Twenty-Fourth Northern Marianas Commonwealth  
17      Legislature, the Senate concurring, that the following personnel is essential for the  
18      delivery of public service and approved by the Legislature:

19              1 General Maintenance, Office of the Governor – Admin. Services

20          **BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED**, that the Speaker of the House of  
21      Representatives and the President of the Senate shall certify and the House Clerk

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1 and the Senate Legislative Secretary shall attest to the adoption of this joint  
2 resolution and thereafter the House Clerk shall transmit a copy to Anthony C.  
3 Torres, Commissioner, Department of Corrections; Natalia M. Sablan, Acting  
4 Secretary, Department of Finance; Virginia C. Villagomez, Special Assistant,  
5 Office of Management and Budget; Joseph M. Pangelinan, Director, Office of  
6 Personnel and Management; and the Honorable David M. Apatang, Governor,  
7 Commonwealth of the Northern Mariana Islands.

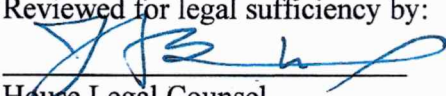
Prefiled: 9/22/2024

Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Introduced by: \_\_\_\_\_

  
Rep. John Paul P. Sablan

Reviewed for legal sufficiency by:

  
House Legal Counsel

Date: 9/22/26